



Our Story

Jali LALC is the traditional country of the Nyangbul people, of the Bundjalung nation.

Cabbage Tree Island (CTI) is approx. 22.5 km southwest of Ballina, and is home for most local Aboriginal community members and is where Jali LALC was established.

The Jali LALC office is based in central Ballina Nyangbul Jugun/Country. The Bundjalung word for Ballina is Bullinah which means 'place of plenty'.

Evans Heads is a culturally significant area to the Bundjalung nation. While operating independently, the Jali, Ngulinga and Bogal Local Aboriginal Land Councils recognised shared overlapping cultural obligations and interests in Evans Heads for its nationwide cultural protection and custodianship. The Jali LALC boundary covers the local government areas of Ballina, and parts of the Byron and Richmond Valley (see Table 1).

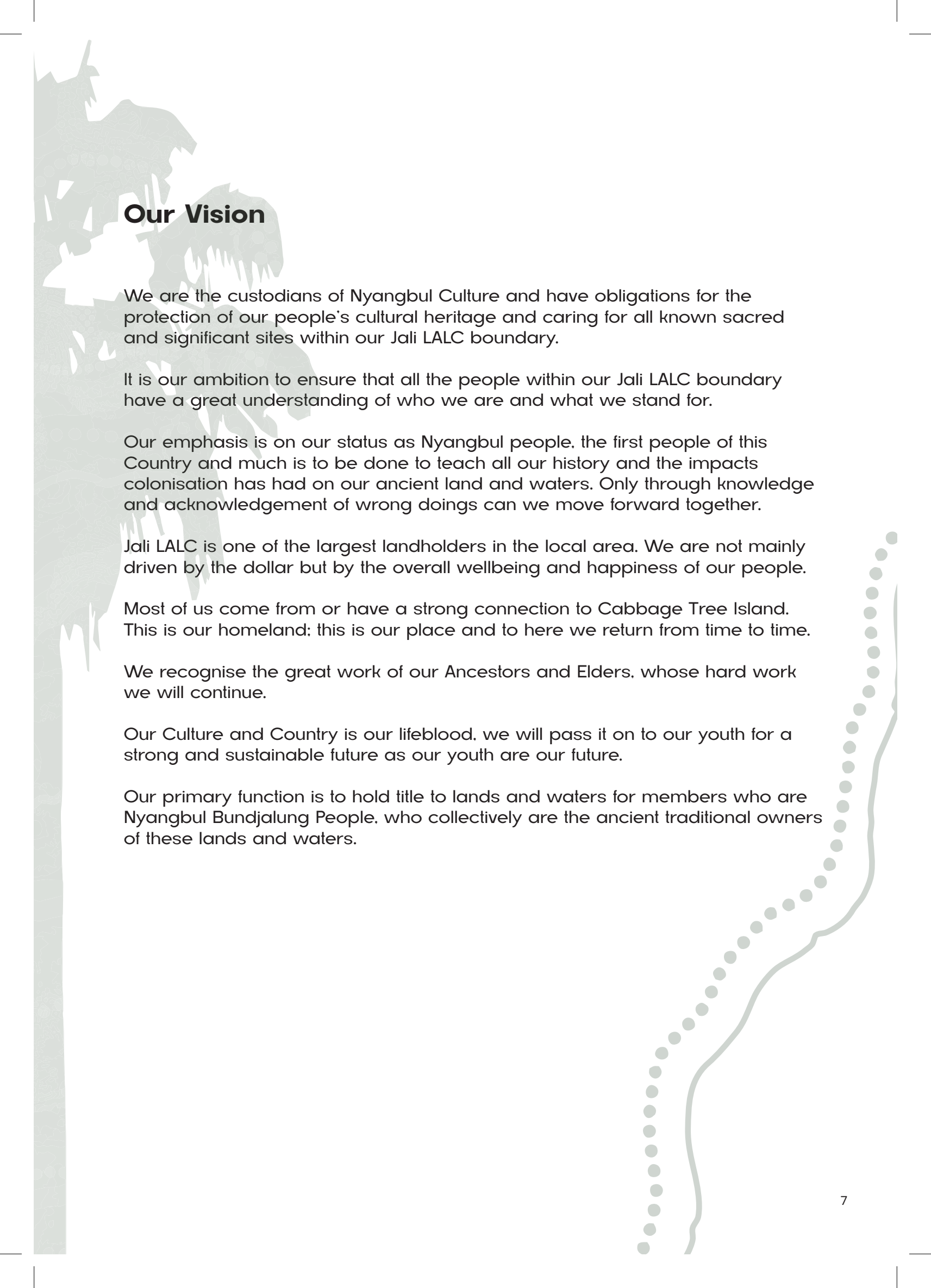
Jali LALC has a total of 1894.55 hectares of total land holdings, which makes it one of the largest land holders in the local area (see Table 2). Jali LALC is active in continuing to pursue land claims under the ALRA. There are pending land claims, still to be determined, made by or on behalf of Jali LALC.

Jali LALC has a membership of over 400 and is governed by a board which are elected every four years by the members. Jali LALC has maintained steady membership since 2021-2024 CLBP.

In late February 2022 CTI was impacted by an unprecedented flood. Our community is resilient and familiar with floods, living safely and effectively with the floods for over 160 years. For the very first time, our community of CTI has still not returned to our home since this flood. This has had devastating effects on those directly impacted and displaced by the flood. This is an urgent priority for Jali LALC.

We come from an ancient and rich past.
We come from the longest living culture in the world.
We are proud of our custodian role and are here to
care for and protect our Country and strengthen our
Culture and heritage for the future of our children.
We will improve our overall cultural and spiritual,
physical, social and economic wellbeing.





Our Vision

We are the custodians of Nyangbul Culture and have obligations for the protection of our people's cultural heritage and caring for all known sacred and significant sites within our Jali LALC boundary.

It is our ambition to ensure that all the people within our Jali LALC boundary have a great understanding of who we are and what we stand for.

Our emphasis is on our status as Nyangbul people, the first people of this Country and much is to be done to teach all our history and the impacts colonisation has had on our ancient land and waters. Only through knowledge and acknowledgement of wrong doings can we move forward together.

Jali LALC is one of the largest landholders in the local area. We are not mainly driven by the dollar but by the overall wellbeing and happiness of our people.

Most of us come from or have a strong connection to Cabbage Tree Island. This is our homeland; this is our place and to here we return from time to time.

We recognise the great work of our Ancestors and Elders, whose hard work we will continue.

Our Culture and Country is our lifeblood, we will pass it on to our youth for a strong and sustainable future as our youth are our future.

Our primary function is to hold title to lands and waters for members who are Nyangbul Bundjalung People, who collectively are the ancient traditional owners of these lands and waters.

Our Guiding Principles

- Respect for our Country, our culture and its obligations as we understand we must pass this on to our young people.
- We respect each other, our Elders and all people.
- We will respect each other, including Directors, staff and members.
- We are here for our Community not ourselves.
- We will be honest and transparent.
- Members are the decisions makers and make decision based on fairness and equity.
- Jali will strive to be sustainable into our future.
- We will promote community participation in making big decisions through self determination.
- We have pride in ourselves and our Land Council.
- We adhere to principals of good governance in accordance to ALRA/ ALRR and associated legislation.



Our decision-making processes will match the way in which we must respect local culture. Key points about our decision making are:

Respect

All members and staff respect each other's views and opinions, even when they are different.

Consensus

Jali LALC prefers to make decisions based on consensus as per the ALRA.

Community Consultation

We may need to talk to the broader local Aboriginal community about some decisions, we like to make sure we make the best decision, so we try and get as many community member's input and advice. The final decision will be based on listening to everyone's input, but it will be made by Jali LALC members.

Transparency

Jali LALC requires having clear information before we make our decisions. We will insist stakeholders come to us with clear and detailed information.

Deferment

We may defer some decisions to seek further information from other appropriate groups or bodies to enable the Members to make fully informed decisions.